

Domain & Hosting — How to give Adverton access

What this is for: to launch your new website at your domain (yourbusiness.com), Adverton needs to either (a) host the site on our infrastructure or (b) be able to publish to your existing host. There are 3 ways to do this — pick the one that fits your situation. **Option 1 is the simplest and the most common.**

Time required: 5–15 minutes depending on the option you pick.

What you'll need: - The login to wherever you bought your domain (the "registrar" — examples: GoDaddy, Namecheap, Google Domains, Hover). - If your website is hosted somewhere different than where you bought the domain, you'll also need that hosting login.

Quick chooser

Your situation	Recommended option
You have a domain. No website yet (or one we'll replace).	Option 1 — DNS delegation. Easiest.
You have a domain. You want to keep your existing website live until ours launches.	Option 1 — DNS delegation when ready. We coordinate the cutover.
You don't have a domain yet.	Option 4 — We register one for you.
You're happy with your current host and want to keep it.	Option 2 — Add Adverton as a user on your host.
You don't want to share access at all.	Option 3 — Transfer your domain to Adverton. Fully managed.

Option 1 — DNS delegation (simplest, recommended)

You keep ownership of your domain at your current registrar. You just point it at Adverton's hosting servers. Takes 5 minutes; the change propagates in 1–24 hours.

Step 1 — Log in to your registrar

Go to the website where you bought your domain. Sign in.

Step 2 — Find DNS settings

Look for one of these labels (varies by registrar): **DNS Settings**, **Manage DNS**, **Nameservers**, or **DNS Records**.

Step 3 — Switch to "Custom Nameservers"

Most registrars have a toggle: "*Use default nameservers*" vs. "*Use custom nameservers*." Choose **custom**.

Step 4 — Enter Adverton's nameservers

We'll send you the exact 2 nameservers in your kickoff email. They look like this:

```
ns1.adverton-hosting.com  
ns2.adverton-hosting.com
```

Paste them in. Save.

Step 5 — Tell us when you've done it

Reply to the kickoff email: "*Done — pointed to your nameservers*." We'll see the change in our dashboard within 24 hours and start building.

What does this mean for your existing email? If you have email at your domain (e.g., owner@yourbusiness.com via Google Workspace or Microsoft 365), tell us BEFORE you switch nameservers. We'll copy your email DNS records into our setup so email keeps working without a hiccup. **Don't skip this step or you'll lose email for a few hours.**

Option 2 — Add Adverton as a user on your existing host

Pick this if you want to keep your current hosting provider (e.g., GoDaddy hosting, Bluehost, SiteGround). You add us as a sub-user on your hosting control panel.

Step 1 — Log in to your hosting account

This is usually a different login from the domain registrar.

Step 2 — Find "Users" or "Team Access" or "FTP Accounts"

Wording varies. On cPanel: **Preferences** → **User Manager**. On Plesk: **Subscriptions** → **Web Users**.

Step 3 — Create a new user

Email: **dev@adverton.net** Password: generate a strong one and send it to us via secure channel (we'll provide a one-time link).

Step 4 — Grant the right permissions

We need: **upload files (FTP/SFTP)**, **edit databases**, **edit DNS for the domain**.

Step 5 — Send us the login info

Reply to the kickoff email with: hosting URL, username (dev@adverton.net), and the secure-link password. We test access within 24 hours.

Heads-up: Option 2 is messier than Option 1 because every host has a different control panel and quirks. If your existing host is slow or limited (common with GoDaddy hosting), the site we build will perform worse than on our own infrastructure. We'll tell you honestly if we recommend switching to Option 1 instead.

Option 3 — Transfer your domain to Adverton

You move ownership of the domain to our registrar account. We handle all of it from there. **Choose this only if you don't want to think about it again.**

Step 1 — Unlock the domain

At your current registrar, find your domain → click **Domain Settings** or similar → toggle **Domain Lock** OFF.

Step 2 — Get the EPP / authorization code

Same screen, click **Get Authorization Code** (sometimes called "Transfer Code" or "EPP Code"). They email it to you within minutes.

Step 3 — Send us the code

Reply to the kickoff email with the EPP code. We initiate the transfer on our side.

Step 4 — Approve the transfer email

Within a few hours you'll receive an email from your current registrar asking you to **approve the outgoing transfer**. Click yes.

Step 5 — Wait 5–7 days

ICANN (the international body that runs domains) imposes a 5-day waiting window on transfers. Nothing for you to do in this window. We'll confirm when the domain is fully on our side.

Cost: transferring a domain renews it for 1 year and costs ~\$15. **We pay this on your behalf** — included in the \$799/mo, no separate charge.

Option 4 — You don't have a domain yet

We register a new domain for you. Cost: ~\$15/year, included.

Step 1 — Tell us 3 domain ideas during onboarding (Form_02)

Examples: - yourbusiness.com - yourbusinessHVAC.com - yourbusiness-[city].com

We check availability for each.

Step 2 — We register the best available one in your name

Registrant info on the domain = your business legal name. **You own it from day one**. Adverton is listed as "administrative contact" so we can manage DNS, but ownership stays yours.

Step 3 — Done

You don't have to do anything. We move directly into building the website.

What happens next

Once we have hosting access (any of Options 1–4): - **Week 1:** we set up the dev environment with your domain pointed at our servers. - **Weeks 2–3:** we build your site using one of our 3 templates, customized with your photos, services, and copy from Form_02. - **Pre-launch:** we send you a preview link. You review, give feedback, we adjust. - **Launch:** site goes live the day you approve. Average end-to-end: 14 days from access granted to site live.

Common issues

"I bought my domain years ago and don't remember which provider." Check old emails for keywords: "domain renewal", "GoDaddy", "Namecheap", "registrar". If still stuck, do a public WHOIS lookup — Google "WHOIS [your-domain]". The result will name the registrar.

"My current site has email connected to it. Will switching break it?" Only if not handled correctly. Tell us during onboarding — we copy over your MX records (the email DNS settings) at the same time as the website cutover. Email stays uninterrupted.

"Can I keep my existing site live during the build?" Yes. We build on a temporary URL (something like `yourdomain.adverton-staging.com`) and only point your real domain at the new site on launch day. Zero downtime.

"I don't have any photos for the website." Not a problem. We use stock photos for trade-specific imagery and only use real photos for the hero section + about page. We can also send a photographer briefing — 30 photos taken with a phone is enough.

Questions: support@adverton.net